NILEGATE-DOC v1

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END-METADATA

1. Purpose

This circular explains how an import container placed under a customs hold at a NileGate terminal is inspected, cleared and released, and who does what at each step.

2. Scope

It covers import containers under any customs hold at NileGate terminals and binds the Customs department, gate staff and the customs brokers who act for consignees.

3. Hold types

3.1 Documentary hold

A documentary hold is placed when the cargo manifest and the bill of lading disagree, an HS code is missing or inconsistent, or a certificate of origin is absent. It is lifted as soon as the broker files corrected documents.

3.2 Physical inspection hold

A physical inspection hold sends the container for an X-ray scan or an opened examination in inspection area C. Scanning slots must be booked at least 24 hours ahead through the customs liaison desk.

3.3 Veterinary and agricultural hold

Food, animal and plant products need a release certificate from the veterinary or agricultural quarantine authority. Reefer units on this hold stay connected to power for the whole hold.

4. Release requirements

A held container is released only when the system shows every hold cleared, the customs release order is signed, the broker's declaration number is recorded and all duties and storage charges are paid.

5. Storage charges during a hold

The first 3 days of a hold are free of storage charges. From day 4 to day 10 the consignee pays 4 SDR per TEU per day, and from day 11 onwards 8 SDR per TEU per day. Charges are not waived when the hold was caused by the consignee's own documents.

6. Escalation

Holds longer than 7 days are reported every week to the customs manager. A consignee who disputes a hold contacts the customs liaison officer, who answers within 2 working days.